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THE KURUKSHETRA OF DIPLOMACY

LEGATIO 4.0 / STUDY GUIDE SERIES

COPUOS

STUDY GUIDE · AGENDA

COPUOS

UNITED NATIONS COMMITTEE ON THE PEACEFUL USES OF OUTER SPACE

AGENDA / FOCUS

Establishing a legally binding framework for the Prevention of an Arms Race in Outer Space (PAROS): regulating anti-satellite weapons and cyber operations targeting space infrastructure.

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THE KURUKSHETRA OF DIPLOMACY

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STUDY GUIDE FOR LEGATIO MODEL UNITED NATIONS

Committee:

United Nations Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space
(COPUOS)

Agenda:

Establishing a Legally Binding Framework for the Prevention of an
Arms Race in Outer Space (PAROS): Regulating Anti-Satellite (ASAT)
Weapons and Cyber Operations Targeting Space Infrastructure

Letter from the Executive Board

Dear Delegates,

It is our distinct pleasure to welcome you to the United Nations Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (COPUOS). At this session, we confront a critical, real-world diplomatic emergency: **Establishing a Legally Binding Framework for the Prevention of an Arms Race in Outer Space (PAROS)**, with an immediate focus on regulating Anti-Satellite (ASAT) weapons and cyber operations targeting space infrastructure.

For decades, space was viewed as a scientific sanctuary belonging to all humanity. Today, that sanctuary is under immense pressure. Human infrastructure on Earth from financial networks and GPS grids to climate tracking and military intelligence is fundamentally tethered to orbit. This reliance has exposed a massive vulnerability. The rapid commercialization of Low Earth Orbit (LEO), the development of kinetic and non-kinetic ASAT weapons, and the invisible threat of cyber warfare targeting satellite constellations have collectively turned space into an operational military domain.

The core crisis you face is a glaring gap in international law. The Outer Space Treaty of 1967 successfully banned weapons of mass destruction in space, but it remains completely silent on conventional weapons, ground-to-space kinetic interceptors, and cyber disruptions. Because of these legal gray areas and deep geopolitical mistrust, the PAROS framework has been stalled in diplomatic gridlock for decades.

As representatives of your nations, your task is to break this deadlock. You must balance your country's legitimate national security interests with the collective obligation to preserve orbit as a sustainable, peaceful resource. We expect you to look past boilerplate political rhetoric and engage in deep, legally rigorous, and highly technical debate. Use this guide as your launchpad, research your country's precise space capabilities, and come prepared to negotiate a framework that prevents a conflict that could permanently devastate global digital infrastructure.

Wishing you fruitful research and dynamic debates,

Kunwar Dipankar

Chairperson

United Nations Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (COPUOS)

Introduction to the Committee

The United Nations Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (COPUOS) was established by the General Assembly in 1959, shortly after the launch of Sputnik 1, under **Resolution 1472 (XIV)**. It was designed to serve as the primary international body tasked with governing the exploration and use of space for the benefit of all humanity, focusing heavily on peace, security, and scientific cooperation.

COPUOS operates via a unique structure consisting of two specialized subcommittees:

- **The Scientific and Technical Subcommittee:** Focuses on space debris mitigation, space weather, global navigation satellite systems, and the long-term sustainability of outer space activities.
- **The Legal Subcommittee:** Evaluates legal issues arising from space exploration, such as space traffic management, the definition of space boundaries, resource utilization, and the implementation of the core UN space treaties.

Historically, COPUOS was the cradle of space law, successfully drafting the five foundational international treaties that govern space today:

Treaty Name	Year	Core Mandate
The Outer Space Treaty (OST)	1967	Establishes space as the "province of all mankind," bans weapons of mass destruction (WMDs) in orbit, and forbids national appropriation/sovereignty claims.
The Rescue Agreement	1968	Mandates that states must render all possible assistance to astronauts in distress and safely return them to their launching state.

The Liability Convention	1972	Establishes absolute liability for launching states to pay financial compensation for damage caused by their space objects on Earth or to aircraft.
The Registration Convention	1975	Requires states to maintain a registry of objects launched into space and provide details to the UN to ensure transparency.
The Moon Agreement	1979	Declares the Moon and its resources the "common heritage of mankind" (though notably unratified by major spacefaring nations).

Mandate and Jurisdictional Challenges

While COPUOS is exceptionally well-suited for setting standards on space sustainability, traffic management, and peaceful legal frameworks, its mandate exists in a delicate, overlapping gray zone with the **Conference on Disarmament (CD)** based in Geneva. Historically, hard military disarmament negotiations have been sent to the CD, while peaceful applications stay within COPUOS.

However, because contemporary space threats blur the line between civilian and military infrastructure (e.g., a cyberattack on a dual-use GPS satellite), COPUOS must step forward. Delegates must carefully navigate this jurisdictional boundary, ensuring that their proposals complement, rather than conflict with, ongoing arms control discussions elsewhere in the UN apparatus.



Introduction to the Agenda

The agenda before this committee addresses the glaring legal vacuum hanging above our atmosphere: **Establishing a legally binding framework for the Prevention of an Arms Race in Outer Space (PAROS), specifically focusing on regulating Anti-Satellite (ASAT) weapons and cyber operations targeting space infrastructure.**

For over forty years, PAROS has been a permanent agenda item in international diplomacy, but it has consistently stalled due to disagreements over verification, definitions, and geopolitical trust. The urgency has surged dramatically because modern life on Earth is completely dependent on space-based assets. Finance networks, agricultural optimization, climate tracking, emergency response, maritime navigation, and global communications all rely on satellites. If space becomes an active warzone, the immediate civilian fallout on Earth would be staggering.

This agenda splits the threat landscape into two distinct fronts:



Front A: Anti-Satellite (ASAT) Weapons

ASAT weapons are designed to incapacitate or destroy satellites for strategic military purposes. They are generally categorized into four main types:

1. **Direct-Ascent Kinetic ASATs:** Ground, air, or sea-launched missiles that physically smash into a satellite at hypersonic speeds, instantly obliterating it.
2. **Co-Orbital ASATs:** "Killer satellites" placed into orbit that maneuver close to a target satellite to detonate, collide, or use robotic arms to disable it.

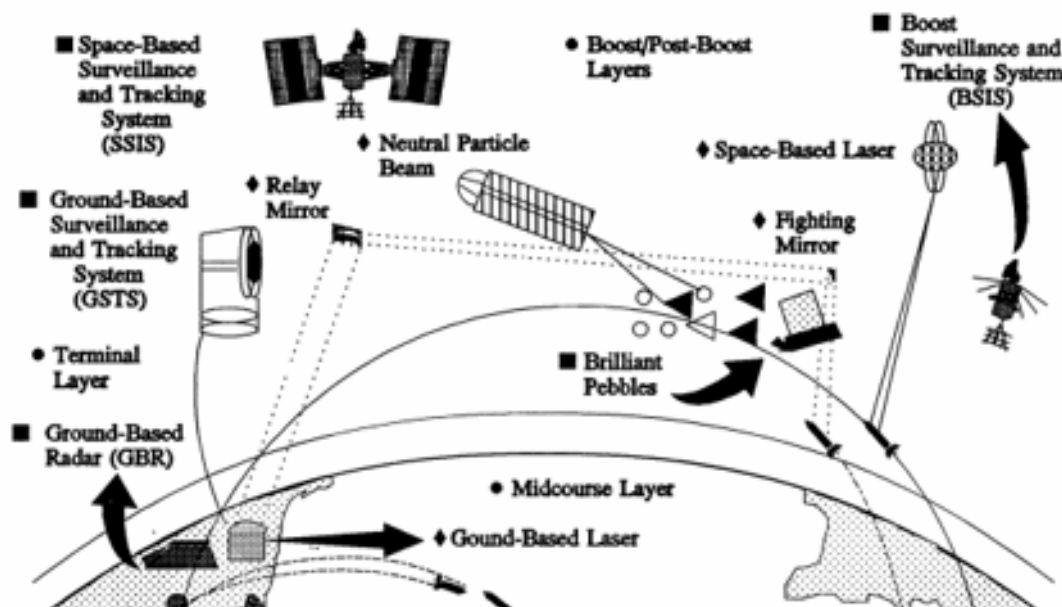
3. **Directed Energy Weapons (DEWs):** Ground-based or space-based lasers, high-powered microwaves, or radiofrequency weapons that dazzle, blind, or fry a satellite's optical sensors and electronic circuitry.
4. **Electronic Warfare (Jamming and Spoofing):** Temporary, non-kinetic interference that blocks satellite downlinks/uplinks or feeds false data to GPS receivers.

Front Space: Cyber Operations

Unlike physical missiles, cyber warfare presents a low-cost, deniable, and highly asymmetric threat to space systems. Cyber operations can target three vulnerable segments of space infrastructure:

- **The Space Segment:** Uploading malicious code directly to the satellite to seize control, drain battery arrays, or permanently brick the system.
- **The Ground Segment:** Hacking ground control stations, satellite dishes, and data centers to disrupt communications or send destructive commands.
- **The Link Segment:** Exploiting vulnerabilities in the radiofrequency data streams connecting the satellite to the ground station, allowing for data interception or command injection.

The ultimate objective of this committee is to move beyond voluntary "best practices" and design a legally binding treaty framework that defines, monitors, and prohibits acts of aggression in these domains.



Historical Ties

To understand why a legally binding PAROS agreement remains unfulfilled, delegates must trace the Cold War history of space militarization and the legal precedents that followed.

1967: Outer Space Treaty (Bans WMDs, leaves conventional loophole)

|

1985: US "Star Wars" / Solwind ASAT Test (Kinetic intercept era begins)

|

2007: Chinese ASAT Test (Creates largest debris cloud in history)

|

2008: PPWT Proposal by Russia/China (Rejected by Western blocs over verification)

|

2021: Russian ASAT Test /S Moratorium (Modern push for kinetic test bans)

The Cold War and the OST Loophole

During the 1960s, the US and USSR raced to dominate space. Fearing nuclear weapons in orbit, they signed the 1967 Outer Space Treaty. Article IV of the OST explicitly states:

"States Parties to the Treaty undertake not to place in orbit around the Earth any objects carrying nuclear weapons or any other kinds of weapons of mass destruction..."

While this successfully prevented nuclearization, it left a massive, fateful loophole: it did **not** ban conventional kinetic weapons, lasers, or cyber technologies. Throughout the late 1970s and 1980s, both superpowers experimented extensively with ASAT programs, culminating in the 1985 US test where an F-15 fighter jet launched an ASM-135 ASAT missile to destroy the dying Solwind P78-1 satellite.

The Modern ASAT Era (2007–Present)

The debate completely shifted on January 11, 2007, when China conducted a direct-ascent ASAT test against its own defunct weather satellite, the FY-1C. The impact occurred at an altitude of 865 kilometers right in the middle of a highly populated Low Earth Orbit. It created the largest, most hazardous space debris cloud in human history, featuring over 3,000 trackable fragments that will remain in orbit for decades, threatening all passing spacecraft.

This was followed by India's "Mission Shakti" ASAT test in 2019 and Russia's direct-ascent ASAT test against the Kosmos 1408 satellite in November 2021, which forced astronauts aboard the International Space Station to scramble into emergency escape capsules due to the passing debris cloud.

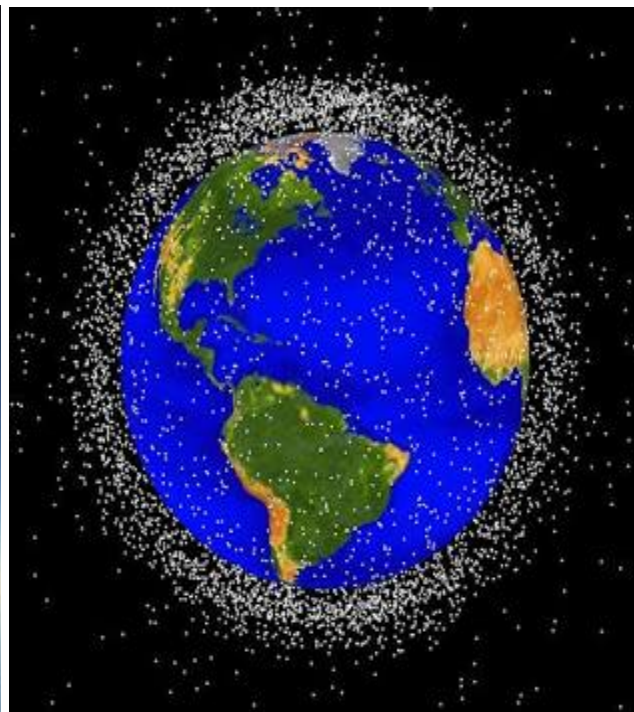
Diplomatic Initiatives and Gridlock

Two major, competing diplomatic solutions have historically dominated the UN landscape:

1. **The PPWT (Treaty on Prevention of the Placement of Weapons in Outer Space):** Jointly proposed by Russia and China in 2008 (and updated in 2014) at the Conference on Disarmament. The PPWT proposes a ban on placing weapons in orbit. However, Western nations, led by the US, have repeatedly rejected it because it completely ignores ground-based direct-ascent ASAT missiles and lacks any strict, independent verification mechanisms.
2. **Voluntary Moratoriums and TCBMs:** In response to the gridlock, Western states have pushed for *Transparency and Confidence-Building Measures* (TCBMs). In 2022, the United Nations General Assembly adopted a resolution calling for a voluntary ban on destructive, direct-ascent kinetic ASAT testing. While over 30 countries pledged to follow it, it remains non-binding and lacks the teeth of a formal treaty.



The 1985 U.S. Direct-Ascent ASAT Missile Test.



The Reality of Space Debris in Low Earth Orbit.
Source: NASA Orbital Debris Program Office

Current Challenges

The challenges currently facing COPUOS are driven by rapid technological acceleration outstripping our legal frameworks. Delegates must address four main crises:

1. The Dual-Use Dilemma

The single greatest technical obstacle to a space arms treaty is that almost all modern space technology is "dual-use" meaning it has both peaceful civilian functions and potential military applications.

For instance, satellites equipped with robotic arms or grappling hooks designed for **Active Debris Removal (ADR)** or satellite servicing can easily be repurposed to approach, grapple, and dismantle an adversary's military satellite. A laser designed to track space junk can easily be dialed up to temporarily blind or permanently damage spy satellite optics. Distinguishing a peaceful civilian satellite maneuvers from an impending co-orbital ASAT attack is almost impossible without intrusive verification.

2. Space Debris and the Kessler Syndrome

Every kinetic ASAT test shatters solid metal and electronics into thousands of unguided, razor-sharp projectiles traveling at speeds exceeding 27,000 kilometers per hour.

If a full-scale kinetic ASAT war breaks out, it could trigger the **Kessler Syndrome** a catastrophic scenario where the density of objects in Low Earth Orbit becomes so high that a single collision sets off a runaway chain reaction of cascading fragments. This would eventually cocoon Earth in a dense sheet of flying shrapnel, destroying all active satellite infrastructure and rendering space completely unusable for generations.

3. Attribution and Deception in Cyber Operations

Cyber operations targeting space systems present severe attribution challenges. If a military communication satellite suddenly loses power or experiences a command system failure, it is incredibly difficult to immediately determine if the disruption was caused by:

- An intentional, hostile cyber attack by a foreign state.
- A rogue hack by a non-state actor or terrorist cell.
- An unpredictable space weather event, such as a solar flare.

Because cyber operations leave minimal forensic evidence in real-time, the risk of miscalculation is dangerously high. A nation might mistake a software bug for a cyber attack, leading to accidental, retaliatory kinetic warfare on Earth.

4. Commercial Satellites in the Crosshairs

The massive expansion of commercial mega-constellations (like SpaceX's Starlink) has fundamentally altered conflict dynamics. During the initial phases of the war in Ukraine, commercial Starlink terminals provided critical battlefield communications to Ukrainian forces. This prompted Russian officials at the UN to declare that commercial space infrastructure used for military purposes could become "legitimate targets for retaliation."

COPUOS must decide: Do private commercial assets lose their protected civilian status under international law if they are utilized by state militaries?

Future Problems

As delegates look toward the horizon, emerging technologies will introduce completely unprecedented legal and strategic headaches that your framework must proactively anticipate.

Proliferation of Autonomous Mega-Constellations

We are moving away from an era of a few dozen high-value, exquisite satellites toward an era of massive distributed networks containing tens of thousands of cheap, mass-produced satellites. If an adversary launches a cyber operation that infects an autonomous mega-constellation, the malware could rapidly spread through inter-satellite laser links. This could turn entire commercial constellations into unguided, drifting orbital hazards outside of ground control.

Hypersonic Glide Vehicles and Fractional Orbital Bombardment

The boundary between a missile strike and space weaponry is dissolving. Nations are currently developing **Hypersonic Glide Vehicles (HGVs)** and Fractional Orbital Bombardment Systems (FOBS). These weapons are launched into Low Earth Orbit, travel partially around the planet, and then re-enter the atmosphere to strike targets at hypersonic speeds.

The Legal Loophole: Because they do not complete a full, sustained orbit around Earth, conventional interpretations of the Outer Space Treaty do not classify them as "placed in orbit." Your framework must clearly define where atmospheric transit ends and orbital placement begins.

Cislunar and Deep Space Militarization

With global superpowers rushing to return to the Moon and establish permanent lunar bases, the strategic landscape is expanding beyond Earth orbit into **Cislunar Space** (the volume of space between Earth and the Moon).

Military agencies are already drafting plans for space domain awareness networks and positioning defensive surveillance satellites at Lagrange points (gravitationally stable positions in space). If a framework is built strictly to protect Low Earth Orbit, it will be obsolete within a decade as military positioning moves to the lunar surface and deep space pathways.

7. 20–25 Questions to be Addressed

Delegates must systematically answer these critical legal, technical, and political questions within their working papers and draft resolutions:

Definitional and Legal Questions

1. How does your nation explicitly define a "weapon in outer space"? Does a weapon require kinetic destructive intent, or do non-kinetic systems (lasers, jammers) qualify?
2. How can international law legally differentiate between an Active Debris Removal (ADR) system and a Co-Orbital Anti-Satellite (ASAT) weapon?
3. Should the voluntary moratorium on destructive direct-ascent kinetic ASAT testing be codified into an unalterable, legally binding treaty?
4. How can the international community establish a clear, universally recognized legal boundary where national airspace ends and sovereign-free outer space begins?
5. What legal mechanisms can resolve the jurisdictional overlap between COPUOS and the Conference on Disarmament regarding space security?
6. How should international humanitarian law (IHL) and its principles of proportionality be applied to non-kinetic space warfare?

Cyber Security and Attribution

7. Under what precise technical conditions does a cyber operation targeting space infrastructure constitute an "armed attack" under Article 51 of the UN Charter?
8. What independent, multilateral framework can be engineered to verify and attribute cyber attacks against satellites to prevent accidental military escalations?
9. Who bears international legal liability if a state hacks a third-party nation's ground station to cause a satellite collision?
10. Should the targeting of purely humanitarian space assets (e.g., climate monitoring, search-and-rescue) via cyber means be banned explicitly as a war crime?
11. How can developing nations be protected from cyber vulnerabilities embedded within commercial space tech imported from major powers?

Commercial and Dual-Use Infrastructure

12. Do commercial satellite constellations forfeit their civilian immunity under international law when they provide telemetry or communication support to active militaries?
13. What international regulatory standards should govern private aerospace corporations during times of global geopolitical conflict?
14. How should the financial and legal liability rules under the 1972 Liability Convention be updated to handle commercial mega-constellations?
15. How can technology transfers for civilian space development be maintained without inadvertently accelerating a recipient nation's dual-use military space program?

Enforcement, Verification, and Future Horizons

16. What realistic, independent technical mechanisms can inspect orbits to verify compliance with an space arms-control treaty without stealing proprietary state technology?
17. Should a specialized, independent UN agency (analogous to the IAEA for nuclear energy) be built to police space traffic and monitor orbital compliance?

18. What punitive legal and economic sanctions should automatically apply to any state that willfully creates massive space debris through kinetic actions?
19. How will a new PAROS framework govern emerging Hypersonic Glide Vehicles (HGVs) that transit through orbital space but do not remain there?
20. How can we extend arms race prevention rules to cover Cislunar space, Lagrange points, and the lunar surface before resource colonization begins?

Different Blocs and Their Perspectives

To pass a resolution in COPUOS, you must understand the deep strategic fault lines that divide the global spacefaring community. Navigating these regional and structural dynamics is essential for building consensus.

The Western Bloc (United States, European Union, Five Eyes, Japan)

- **Core Philosophy:** Focus on regulating the *behavior* and *conduct* of actors in space, rather than trying to ban specific hardware or physical technologies (which they argue are impossible to classify due to the dual-use dilemma).
- **Key Stances:**
 - Strongly champion voluntary Transparency and Confidence-Building Measures (TCBMs), such as the moratorium on destructive kinetic ASAT testing.
 - Firmly reject the Sino-Russian PPWT proposal, arguing it is unverifiable and conveniently leaves ground-based ASAT missiles completely unregulated.
 - Seek robust space traffic management frameworks to safeguard their massive, high-value commercial and military satellite networks.

The Sino-Russian Bloc (People's Republic of China, Russian Federation, CSTO)

- **Core Philosophy:** Focus strictly on creating legally binding bans on placing physical *hardware and weapons into orbit*, arguing that behavior-based guidelines are a western strategy designed to avoid real disarmament.
- **Key Stances:**
 - Continually push for the adoption of the **Prevention of the Placement of Weapons in Outer Space Treaty (PPWT)**.
 - View Western commercial mega-constellations (like Starlink) as integrated elements of Western military power that threaten their national security.
 - Often resist Western-led voluntary initiatives, viewing them as attempts to dictate international space rules without undergoing formal, multilateral treaty negotiations at the UN.

The Emerging Spacefaring Bloc (India, Brazil, Israel, South Korea)

- **Core Philosophy:** Intensely protective of their sovereign technological development, refusing to let new security frameworks close the door on their rising domestic space industries.
- **Key Stances:**

- **India:** Holds a unique middle-ground perspective. It successfully demonstrated its kinetic ASAT capability in 2019 to secure its seat at the top table of space powers, yet remains a vocal opponent of space weaponization and debris creation.
- This bloc generally supports increased space security but is highly cautious of any overly restrictive verification measures that could be used by older superpowers for corporate espionage or to suppress emerging commercial space programs.

The Non-Aligned Movement & Group of 77 (Developing Nations)

- **Core Philosophy:** Space must remain the "common heritage of mankind." They fear that an unrestricted space arms race among great powers will destroy the orbital environment, cutting off developing nations before they can ever build their own space programs.
- **Key Stances:**
 - Vehemently demand that any PAROS framework include strict, legally binding provisions that guarantee **equal access to space** and mandatory technology transfers for peaceful development.
 - Argue that the current geopolitical focus on space militarization dangerously diverts vital global resources away from using space data to solve earthly challenges like climate change, agricultural poverty, and disaster management.

ROPs & Delegate Handbook

Quorum is the **minimum number of delegates who must be present** in the committee for debate or voting to officially begin. It ensures that decisions are made with enough participation and are valid.

Types of Quorum in MUN

1. Simple Quorum

- Needed to start the session and open debate.
- Usually **one-third of all registered delegates** must be present.
- Example: If there are 60 delegates registered, at least 20 must be present to start.

2. Majority Quorum

- Required for **voting on substantive matters** (like draft resolutions and amendments).
- This means **more than half** of the registered delegates must be present. ○

Example: If there are 60 delegates, at least 31 must be in the room to vote.

Why Quorum Matters

- Without quorum, the committee cannot:
 - Start debate.
 - Enter into voting procedure.
 - Pass resolutions or amendments.
- It makes sure decisions are **fair and representative**, not decided by only a few countries.

How the Chair Checks Quorum

- At the beginning of each session, the **Chair takes Roll Call**.
- This helps confirm whether quorum is met.
- If quorum is not met, the committee waits until enough delegates arrive.

2. Setting the Agenda

At the start of the first session, delegates must decide **which topic to discuss first** if there are multiple topics listed for the committee. This process is called *setting the agenda*.

- A delegate raises a **motion to set the agenda** for a chosen topic.
- The Chair may allow short **speeches for and against** that choice.
- After discussion, the committee votes.
- The topic that wins becomes the first one debated. The other topic(s) are discussed later if time allows.

Example:

“The delegate of Germany moves to set the agenda to Topic A: Cybersecurity.”

If the motion passes, the committee starts with Cybersecurity. If not, delegates may propose another motion for Topic B.

3. Roll Call

At the beginning of every committee session, the **Chair calls out each country’s name** to check attendance. This is called *Roll Call*.

- When your country is called, you must respond with either:
 - **“Present”** – You are here and may **vote Yes, No, or Abstain** on resolutions.
 - **“Present and Voting”** – You are here and may only vote **Yes or No** (no abstentions allowed).

Why Roll Call is Important:

- Confirms **who is present** and if quorum is met.
- Decides **who can participate in debate and voting**.
- Keeps the committee organized and formal.

Example:

Chair: *“France?”*

Delegate of France: *“Present and Voting.”*

4. General Speakers’ List (GSL)

The **General Speakers’ List** is the **default form of debate** in Model UN. It is where delegates give formal speeches about the agenda topic.

- At the start of debate, the Chair will open the GSL.
- Delegates raise their placards if they want to be added.
- The Chair makes a list of countries in the order they raise their placards.
- Each delegate speaks when it’s their turn.

Key Points:

- **Speaking Time:** Set by the Chair (usually 1–2 minutes per delegate).
- **Content:** Delegates introduce their country’s stance, propose ideas, or respond to others.
- **Continuity:** If the list runs out, the Chair asks again who wants to be added.

Why the GSL is Important:

- It allows **equal opportunity** for all countries to express their positions.
- Helps shape the **direction of debate** before moving into caucuses.

- It's the best time to **present your country's main policies**.

Example:

Chair: *"The General Speakers' List is now open. Delegates wishing to be added, please raise your placards."*

5. Moderated Caucus

A **Moderated Caucus** is a **temporary suspension of the General Speakers' List** that allows delegates to discuss a specific sub-topic in a more dynamic way. Instead of waiting for the GSL, the Chair directly calls on delegates to speak.

How It Works:

- A delegate raises a **motion for a moderated caucus**, stating:
 1. **Total time** (e.g., 10 minutes).
 2. **Speaking time** (e.g., 30 seconds per delegate).
 3. **Topic of focus** (e.g., border security, refugee protection, etc.).
- If the motion passes, the Chair selects delegates to speak one by one until time runs out.

Why It's Useful:

- Speeds up debate and keeps it **focused on a single issue**.
- Allows for **short, direct interventions** instead of long speeches.
- Helps delegates **exchange views quickly** and build ideas for resolutions.

Example Motion:

"The delegate of Kenya would like to raise a motion to start a moderated caucus on the topic humanitarian aid delivery for 15 mins where each delegate will be getting 90 seconds each."

(In this the total time needs to be equally divisible, Like 15mins/90secs means 10 Delegate will get a chance to speak)

6. Unmoderated Caucus

An **Unmoderated Caucus** is an informal session where delegates can **move around, talk freely, and negotiate without the Chair controlling the speaking order.**

How It Works:

- A delegate raises a **motion for an unmoderated caucus**, stating:
 - The **duration** (e.g., 15 minutes).
- If the motion passes, delegates leave their seats, form groups, and discuss openly.

What Delegates Do During Unmoderated Caucus:

- **Negotiate and build alliances.**
- **Draft working papers or resolutions.**
- **Merge ideas with other delegations.**
- **Convince other countries to support your proposals.**

Why It's Important:

- This is where the **real deal-making happens** in MUN.
- Helps turn debate speeches into **actual documents and solutions.**
- Encourages teamwork and diplomacy.

Example Motion:

“The delegate of Brazil moves for a 15-minute unmoderated caucus to draft working papers.”

7. Round-Table Talk

A **Round-Table Talk** is a **discussion format where every delegate speaks in a sequence**, usually going around the room in order. Unlike GSL or caucuses, it is more structured and ensures **everyone gets a chance to talk**.

How It Works:

- The Chair sets the speaking time (e.g., 1 minute per delegate).
- Delegates speak one by one, usually in alphabetical order of countries or seating arrangement.
- No placard raising is needed since everyone will be called automatically.

Why It's Useful:

- Makes sure **all voices are heard**, even quieter delegates.
- Helps gather **a wide range of perspectives** on the topic.
 - Works well in **small committees** or when the Chair wants balanced participation.

Example:

Chair: *"We will now have a round-table talk. Each delegate will have 1 minute to state their country's position, starting with Afghanistan."*

8. Points

In MUN, **points are formal ways for delegates to interrupt the debate** to ask questions, clarify rules, or address personal issues. Points are **raised to the Chair**, not directly to other delegates (unless it's a Point of Information).

Types of Points:

a. Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

- Used to **ask the Chair about rules or procedures**.
- Example: "Point of Parliamentary Inquiry: Could the Chair clarify how many

speakers we need for the moderated caucus?”

b. Point of Personal Privilege

- Used when a delegate **cannot hear**, is uncomfortable, or has a personal issue affecting participation.
- Example: “Point of Personal Privilege: The delegate cannot hear the speaker clearly.”

c. Point of Order

- Raised when **rules of procedure are not being followed**.
- The Chair will decide if the point is valid.
- Example: “Point of Order: The previous speaker exceeded the allotted time.”

d. Point of Information

- Allows a delegate to **ask a question to the current speaker** after their speech.
- Must be approved by the Chair.
- Example: After a speech, a delegate asks: “Point of Information: Could the delegate clarify how their proposal addresses refugee rights?”

Key Notes:

- Points are **not used to express opinions** or debate.
- They are **formal tools to maintain clarity and fairness** in the committee.

9. Rights

In MUN, **rights are special privileges that allow a delegate to respond in certain situations**, especially when their country's reputation or dignity is at stake.

a. Right of Reply

- A delegate can request this **if another delegate insults or attacks their country's integrity or national honor**.
- The Chair decides whether the right of reply is allowed and how much time is given (usually 30–60 seconds).
- This is **not used for general disagreements**, only for personal or national attacks.

Example:

If a delegate says, "*The delegate of Country X is lying about its actions,*" the delegate of Country X may raise a Right of Reply to respond.

10. Pleas

In MUN, **pleas are requests made by delegates** to participate in debate beyond regular speaking rules. They are formal ways to ask permission from the Chair.

a. Plea to Reply

- A delegate uses this to **respond directly to a question or statement** addressed to them.
- Example: After being asked a question during a debate, the delegate may say:
"*The delegate of India requests a plea to reply.*"
- The Chair will then allow the response for a set time.

b. Plea to Follow-Up

- After asking a question to another delegate, you may request an **additional question related to the first one**.
- Example: "*The delegate of France requests a plea to follow-up.*"

- This ensures clarity or deeper understanding on specific points.

Key Notes:

- Pleas are **formal and must be approved by the Chair**.
- They allow delegates to **interact more directly** without breaking procedural rules. ●

Always keep the language **diplomatic and respectful**.

11. Yields

After finishing a speech, a delegate may have **remaining speaking time**. Instead of leaving it unused, they can “yield” it. Yielding is **giving your remaining time to someone else or back to the committee**.

Types of Yields:

a. Yield to Questions and Comments

- The remaining time is used for **other delegates to ask questions or make comments** about your speech.
- Example: “The delegate of Japan yields the floor to questions and comments.”

b. Yield to Next Delegate

- The remaining time is given to a **specific delegate** to continue speaking. ●

Example: “The delegate of Canada yields the floor to the delegate of Mexico.”

c. Yield to the Floor

- The remaining time is returned to the **Chair**, who can then decide how to use it. ●

Example: “The delegate of Germany yields the floor to the Chair.”

Key Notes:

- Yielding is **optional** and only applies if you have unused time.
- Helps keep debate **organized and flexible**.
- Allows for **clarifications, questions, or collaborative discussion** without wasting time.

12. Motion

A **motion** is a **formal proposal made by a delegate** to take a specific action in the committee. Motions are used to **control the flow of debate**, make decisions on procedures, or request changes in how the session is conducted.

Common Types of Motions

- **Motion to Set the Agenda** – Decide which topic to discuss first.
- **Motion for a Moderated Caucus** – Temporarily focus debate on a sub-topic.
- **Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus** – Free discussion or negotiation.
- **Motion to Suspend the Meeting** – Break or end the session temporarily.
- **Motion to Adjourn the Meeting** – End the committee session permanently.

How to Raise a Motion

1. Raise your placard to get the Chair's attention.
2. Formally state your motion:

Format:

"The delegate of [Country] would like to raise a motion to [action]."

Example:

"The delegate of Egypt would like to raise a motion for a 10-minute moderated caucus with 45-second speaking time on cybersecurity."

3. The Chair may allow **short speeches for or against** the motion.

4. The committee votes. If it passes, the motion is implemented.

13. Position Paper Writing

A **position paper** is a **short document written by each delegate before the conference**. It explains their country's **views, policies, and proposed solutions** on the agenda topics.

Purpose of a Position Paper

- Shows that a delegate **understands the topic and their country's stance**. ●

Helps delegates **organize arguments and ideas** for debate.

- Can be used to **build alliances and support resolutions** during the conference.

Structure of a Position Paper

1. **Heading:** Include your country, committee, and topic.
2. **Introduction / Background:** Briefly describe the issue.
3. **Country's Position:** Explain what your country thinks about the issue, including past actions or policies.
4. **Proposed Solutions:** Suggest practical ways to address the problem.

SAMPLE POSITION PAPER



Committee : Social, Cultural and Humanitarian Committee

Agenda : Indigenous People and Climate Justice: Safeguarding Cultural Heritage

Country : The Kingdom of Sweden

As the world grapples with the pressing challenges with the climate change where the Indigenous people are affected by it not only the indigenous people are endangered but cultural heritages are also affected by it, with a particular focus on combating with this Agenda .In alignment with our commitment to the Agenda,we seek to propose comprehensive solutions within the framework of the Social, Cultural and Humanitarian Committee.

The Kingdom of Sweden acknowledges the presence of Indigenous people and Climate Justice while Safeguarding cultural heritages within its borders. We are all quite concerned about the increasing effects of climate change, but the indigenous Sami people are particularly affected, and this is obviously very important. Climate change has a significant impact on Sámi culture. Of course, there are other people and situations in which cultural rights and climate change are related. But in the context of Sámi culture, these responses emphasize rights, culture, and climate change.The Sami people of Sweden elect the Sami Parliament (the Sámediggi) to protect and advance their rights, culture, way of life, and languages. Indigenous peoples in Sweden, such as the Sami, are at risk of losing their traditional knowledge and cultural heritage as a result of a variety of circumstances, including modernization, urbanization, and climate change. This loss jeopardizes not only these groups' distinct cultural identity, but also their ability to adapt and respond to environmental changes.

Solutions:

- Implement and fund Indigenous community-led education programs to transmit traditional knowledge and cultural practices to future generations.

- Enhance legal safeguards for Indigenous sacred places and customary territory to prevent invasion by development projects or extractive industries.
- Encourage meaningful collaboration among Indigenous communities, government agencies, and non-governmental organizations (NGOs) to address climate change consequences and conserve cultural heritage.
- Develop climate change adaptation techniques in conjunction with Indigenous groups, incorporating their traditional knowledge of local ecosystems and weather patterns.

Sites:

- www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/Documents/Issues/CulturalRights/Call_ClimateChange/Sweden.docx
- <https://www.imsweden.org/en/what-we-do/how-we-work/climate-justice/>
- www.un.org/development/desa/indigenouspeoples
- <https://www.indigenousclimate.org/>

Resolution Writing

A **resolution** is a **formal document that proposes solutions** to the issues discussed in the committee. It is the **final product of debate**, supported by multiple delegates or countries.

Purpose of a Resolution

- Summarizes the **committee's decisions and recommendations**. ●

Shows **agreement among delegates** on solutions.

- Follows the **United Nations format** to be considered official.

Structure of a Resolution

1. **Heading:** Include the committee name, topic, and sponsors.

2. Preambulatory Clauses:

- Provide **background and context**.
- Start with words like: *“Recalling,” “Recognizing,” “Deeply Concerned,” “Affirming”*.
- Explain why the issue matters and what the UN has done before. 3.

Operative Clauses:

- List **specific actions or recommendations**.
- Start with action words like: *“Calls upon,” “Encourages,” “Requests”*. ○

Each clause is numbered.

4. Signatories and Sponsors:

- Sponsors are countries who wrote the resolution.

- Signatories support discussion but may not fully sponsor it.

Tips for Writing a Resolution

- Be **realistic**; don't propose impossible actions.
- Use **formal, diplomatic language**.
- Ensure clauses are **clear and actionable**.
- Collaborate with other delegates to **gain support** before submission.

Example Operative Clause:

“Calls upon all member states to enhance cybersecurity cooperation through information-sharing agreements and joint training programs.”